

Company: Russell Investments

Job Profile: Technology Intern

Offer Type: Internship Only

Internship Stipend: Rs. 60000

Location: Mumbai (Goregaon)

Process Date: March and April 2025

Placement Process:

Russell Investments conducted their first internship drive in India for our batch which included many roles. TPO informed us about 3 roles: Technology Intern, Business Process Automation Intern, Investment Research Intern. The rest of the interview process was done completely at their office or through online interviews. The HRs informed us directly about rounds through mail or calls.

1. **Written Test (40 minutes)**[30 on day 1 and approx. ~25 on day 2]

- 10 Aptitude MCQ
- 10 CS Fundamental MCQ
- 3 coding questions (Attempt any 2) - Valid Parenthesis, Binary Search Pseudo code, Find Second Max Element in array.

This test was very easy. Also, this was not an elimination round.

2. **Technical Interview 1** [30 on day 1 and approx. ~25 on day 2]

This interview was conducted by a Frontend Developer and Devops Engineer.

The interview focused mainly on my resume. The discussion was regarding my internship and my projects. Apart from this I was asked 1 leetcode easy question - find common elements in 2 strings. A few database related questions were asked as well.

3. **Technical Round 2** [No of candidates who appeared for this round]

This round was conducted by the Director of Application Development.

The interviewer focused on my resume. He asked me questions about my projects from a business perspective. Like why would organizations choose my applications above other companies or build it in house. I was questioned about SDLC and Testing. Apart from that, I was asked about my interests. The interview ended with me asking him questions.

Till here, the entire process was conducted in 1 day at their office. The selected candidates(6 total - 4 from day 1 and 2 from day 2) were allotted the role Intern, Application Development.

The process was over and I assumed that I had been rejected. But a week later, I received a call from the HR that they wished to conduct additional rounds in my case. At that time, I asked HR clearly if the rounds were for the same role to which she said yes. Later on, I got to know that the additional interviews were for the Automation team.

Technical Interview 3

This round was conducted by Application Development Manager in the Automation Team on Microsoft Teams.

I was asked a leetcode easy question on arrays and a question on joins in SQL. I was asked 4 principles of OOP which I explained with examples. I was asked to write an efficient sorting algorithm that sorts the array till a particular index only. I chose to write the Merge Sort Algorithm. I was asked some CCN questions related to HTTP and Rest APIs which I don't remember now.

Managerial Round

This round was taken by the Head of Automation online a week after the previous interview.

She asked me to introduce myself and share my resume. She asked me the language I was most comfortable in and asked me to rate myself in it. I rated myself 7/10 in C++ and said it was the language I used for DSA and CP. She googled C++ and asked me a very random question related to pointers. I was not able to answer the question. I did not know that keyword but explained pointers in C++ and why they are important. This discussion went on for 15 minutes where we discussed the difference between C++ and Java, use of C++ for building games, etc. As the allotted time was over, I was unable to ask any questions.

A few hours later, I received the mail that I have been selected for the technology intern role.

When I received my offer letter it said 'Intern, Data Automation'. That is when I realised I was interviewing for a different team in my last 2 interviews. So, finally 8 technology interns(of which 5 were from SPIT) were selected with 6 in App Dev and 2 in Automation. There is not much difference in the roles, I guess, as we worked on the same projects and technologies.

I am writing this interview experience 5 months after my interviews. So, I am not able to recall all the questions. But from a preparation perspective for Russell, you need to have a strong hold over CS Fundamentals and know your resume well. Also, practice aptitude if necessary.

Useful Tips:

For preparing for placements and internships, be prepared with:

DSA: It is asked by most companies in Online Assessments and Interviews. Without DSA, you won't be able to clear OA and appear for interviews. Apart from doing DSA sheets also give contests to practice solving questions randomly with a time limit. If possible, do CP. It is not necessary but being good at CP gives an edge in OA.

Aptitude: Some companies ask aptitude questions in OA. I did not explicitly practise as I was confident about it but do practise if you are not sure.

CS Fundamentals: These are very important for interviews and OA.

OOPS in Java (and your preferred language as well), SQL, DBMS are most important. OS, CCN and system design are also important.

Resume: You should know your resume well. Have 2 good projects in your resume. It's good to have internships but not necessary.

Communication is very important in interviews and be prepared for HR Type questions as well. Companies might have other requirements like Machine Coding Rounds, Puzzles, Group Discussion, guesstimates, etc.

CGPA is important. Try to keep your CGPA above 8 (ideally 8.5). Many companies had their shortlisting criteria for OA as 8 and for some it was 7.5 and so on. The higher your CGPA, the more companies you get to appear. Initially, only CGPA till 5th semester was being considered for placements. From 2nd week of august, CGPA till 6th semester was considered. Also make sure you don't have any active backlogs

Feel free to connect and ask questions: [Linkedin](#)

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